fn find_min_covering

Michael Shoemate

This proof resides in **"contrib"** because it has not completed the vetting process.

Proves soundness of `find_min_covering` in `mod.rs` at commit f5bb719 (outdated[1]).
`find_min_covering` attempts to return the smallest covering from `sets` that spans `must_cover`.

1 Hoare Triple

Precondition

Compiler-verified

- Argument `must_cover` is of type `BTreeSet<T>`
- Argument `sets` is of type `HashMap<BTreeSet<T>, u32>`
- Generic `T` is some type that implements Hash and has total Ord, so that it can be used in a B-tree set.

Human-verified

None

Pseudocode

```python
def find_min_covering(
    must_cover: set[T], sets: list[set[T], u32]
) -> list[tuple[set[T], u32]] | None:

    covered = list()  #

    while must_cover:  #

        def score(pair):
            by, weight = pair
            return len(by & must_cover), -len(by), -weight

        best_match = max(sets.items(), key=score)

        if best_match is None or best_match[0].isdisjoint(must_cover):
            return None
        best_set, weight = best_match

        must_cover -= best_set  #
        covered[best_set] = weight

    return covered
```

[1] See new changes with `git diff f5bb719..952a66d rust/src/domains/polars/frame/mod.rs`

Postcondition

Return a subset of `sets` whose intersection contains `must_cover`, or None.

2 Proofs

Proof. All that needs to be proven is that the return set covers `must_cover`. While the algorithm makes a best effort to minimize the cardinality of the cover, nothing about optimality of the algorithm has been proven.

The algorithm initializes with an empty cover on 5 and continues to run until all elements have been added to the cover (see 7). If there are no remaining sets that intersect with `must_cover`, then the algorithm terminates without a cover, which is a valid output.

Otherwise, on `state`, a new set is added to the cover and those elements in `must_cover` are removed. The algorithm only terminates once all members of `must_cover` have had sets that include them added to `covered`.

Therefore `covered` returns a subset of `sets` whose intersection contains `must_cover`, or None.

□